

CUSTOMER & MVP BLUEPRINT

Coding/Tech-Skill Self-Paced Companion — for Tier-2 India College Students

Prepared for: Kalpana Yadav (Founder)
Source: Startup Validation Report v2 (Aug 3, 2026)
Market: India — Tier-2 UP first

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The founder's original “self-paced growth for every age” concept was narrowed in the Validation Report to a single testable wedge: a self-paced coding/tech-skill companion for Tier-2 India engineering students — chosen specifically because the founder is inside this exact segment (B.Tech CS, Tier-2 UP). This blueprint translates that validated positioning into a concrete customer profile and a buildable MVP scope.

Current state: zero users, zero interviews, Founder-Market Fit 5.3/10, no direct competitor owns this specific niche (coding-focused, community-distributed, student-only). The path forward is customer conversations and a manual pilot before any real software gets built — this blueprint gives the ICP, persona, MVP scope, and 30-day plan to do that.

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE

Attribute	Profile
Who	18–22, B.Tech/engineering CS students, Tier-2 UP (Firozabad/NCR-adjacent colleges)
Behavior	Learns informally via YouTube/GitHub tutorials; starts projects, rarely finishes them
Trigger	Placement season or a specific project goal (“ship X before internship season”)
Trust posture	Skeptical of new learning apps post-Byju's collapse; peer proof beats ads
Willingness to pay	Low initially — freemium expected; monetization deferred past validation

BUYER PERSONA — “ROHAN,” THE TUTORIAL-STUCK CS STUDENT

Attribute	Detail
Age/Role	20, 3rd-year B.Tech CS, Tier-2 UP college
Goal	Finish one real, shareable coding project — not restart another tutorial
Frustration	Unstructured YouTube content, no follow-through, coursework doesn't map to what recruiters ask for
Decision driver	A classmate's proof of a finished project beats any ad
Channels	WhatsApp/Telegram batch groups, GitHub, Instagram

TOP 10 CUSTOMER PAIN POINTS

1	Tutorials started, never finished — no accountability loop
2	Coursework doesn't translate into a demonstrable portfolio project
3	No clear path through free content — too much choice, no sequence
4	Generic pacing — too slow on known topics, too fast on new ones
5	No feedback on whether current skill level matches project ambition
6	Motivation drop-off after week 1–2 of self-learning
7	Skepticism toward paid learning apps after Byju's-style failures
8	Isolation — learning alone with no peer accountability
9	Placement pressure with no time to explore broad content libraries
10	Can't tell if a project is “good enough” to show recruiters

CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Stage	What Happens	Founder's Job
Awareness	Hears from a classmate/batch group, not an ad	Seed personally in 2–3 known networks first
Consideration	Checks if it fits his current skill + project goal	60-second onboarding: skill level + goal
Purchase (free trial)	Tries first module/session	Deliver a visible win within minutes
Retention	Returns, finishes a real project, shares it	Progress tracking + shareable finished output

KEY CUSTOMER OBJECTIONS

- “I can just use free YouTube/ChatGPT for this.”
- “I've tried learning apps before and quit within weeks.”
- “Why trust a new app after seeing EdTech promises collapse (Byju's)?”
- “Is this actually personalized, or just another tutorial library?”

KEY BUYING TRIGGERS

- Upcoming placement/internship season needing a portfolio project
- Semester-start “fresh start” motivation window
- A classmate showing a finished, working project
- A specific, named project goal with a deadline

MVP RECOMMENDATION

Build first

- A single guided project track (one language/stack) that takes a student from zero to one finished, demo-able project
- Lightweight progress tracking (steps completed, visible “win” early)
- A shareable output at the end (GitHub repo/README, before-after skill snapshot)

Do NOT build

- Multi-interest content library (design, music, etc.) — scope creep that breaks the wedge
- AI/LLM personalization layer — no Python/AI stack yet; sequence this after validation
- Payment/monetization flow — premature before demand is confirmed
- User accounts/social features beyond a simple progress view

Success metrics (30-day pilot)

Metric	Target
Interview pain confirmation	8+ of 20 students confirm the problem unprompted
Landing page conversion	10%+ visitor-to-signup from known traffic
Pilot return rate	5+ of 10 pilot users return for a 2nd session unprompted

MOSCOW PRIORITIZATION

Priority	Items
Must Have	One guided project track; progress steps; a finished shareable output
Should Have	Simple streak/habit nudge; basic peer-visible progress
Could Have	A second project track (adjacent skill); light community/forum
Won't Have (this phase)	AI personalization; payments; multi-interest breadth; native mobile app

PRICING HYPOTHESIS

Freemium: first guided project track free (this is the trust-building, portfolio-proof phase). Paid tier deferred until after the 30-day pilot confirms retention — hypothesis to test later: a low-price (≈₹199-399/month) tier unlocking additional project tracks, not a paywall on the first one.

TOP 5 RISKS

Risk	Mitigation
Scope creep back to “every interest”	Hold to one project track through the full pilot
Zero validation — building before testing demand	Interviews + manual pilot before any code
Post-Byju’s trust deficit slows adoption	Distribute via peer/classmate channels, not ads
Founder time constraints (side project)	Timebox to 30 days, fixed weekly deliverables
No AI/Python skill yet limits future differentiation	Sequence Python after this pilot, not during

30-DAY MVP PLAN

Week	Focus	Threshold to Pass
1	Narrow + map channels; test problem statement on 5 classmates	3+/5 recognize the problem unprompted
2	15–20 student interviews via named channels	8+/20 confirm the pain unprompted
3	Build landing page (also first GitHub portfolio piece)	10%+ visitor-to-signup conversion
4	Manual pilot with 5–10 sign-ups	5+/10 return for a 2nd session

FOUNDER ACTION SHEET — TOP 10 NEXT ACTIONS

1. Write the 1-line problem statement for the coding-project-completion angle
2. Test it on 5 classmates for unprompted recognition
3. Identify 2-3 WhatsApp/Telegram/college groups to run interviews in
4. Run 15-20 listening-only interviews — no pitching
5. Log quotes/evidence; check against the 8/20 threshold before proceeding
6. Choose one language/stack for the first guided project track
7. Build a single-flow HTML/Tailwind landing page describing the offer
8. Share the page only in mapped channels; track visitor-to-signup rate
9. Manually deliver the pilot experience to 5-10 sign-ups via chat
10. Score Week 4 return rate; go/no-go on building real software

SCORES (0-100)

[illegible]

Customer Clarity and Problem Severity score moderately — the ICP is now specific and the pain pattern (unfinished tutorials, no portfolio proof) is plausible, but neither is interview-confirmed yet. PMF Potential and MVP Readiness stay lower deliberately: no user has touched anything yet, and readiness should rise only as Weeks 2–4 produce real signal.

FINAL VERDICT

PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

A specific, testable wedge now exists (coding/project-completion for Tier-2 CS students) with a founder who has real channel access to it — but zero interviews and zero pilot users means this is not yet a demand signal, just a well-formed

hypothesis. Revisit this verdict after Week 4 of the 30-day plan using the thresholds above.

This blueprint is derived from the Startup Validation Report v2 (Aug 3, 2026) and founder-supplied inputs. Directional analysis, not investment or legal advice.